

An illustration of a person's hands typing on a laptop keyboard. The laptop screen displays a user interface with various icons and text, including 'Objectives', 'Secrets', 'Connections', 'Tree', 'Data', 'Generation', and 'APN'. The background is dark with some foliage on the right side.

EXERCISE 10

Content Creation Using Prompt Patterns

This exercise explores how the structure of your prompts directly shapes the quality, coherence, creativity, and organisation of AI-generated content. You will experiment with five powerful prompting techniques, compare their outputs, and develop a sharper intuition for engineering effective prompts across different content formats.

Exercise Objective

The core goal of this exercise is to demonstrate that **how you ask matters just as much as what you ask**. A well-structured prompt can transform a vague, generic response into a polished, insightful piece of content. By the end of this exercise, you will be able to identify which prompt patterns work best for different content goals and contexts.

Quality

Produce content that is accurate, well-reasoned, and professionally written.

Coherence

Ensure ideas flow logically and the content holds together as a unified whole.

What You Will Do

Unlock original, engaging, and imaginative

This exercise is hands-on and iterative. You will move through four key stages, each building on the last. Follow the sequence carefully to get the most out of the learning experience.

Structure

Control the format, organisation, and layout of

01

Create Prompts

Design prompts for content generation using each of the five suggested techniques. Be intentional about the structure and wording you choose.

02

Generate Content

Use your prompts to produce reports, articles, case studies, or creative pieces. Try to keep the topic consistent across techniques for fair comparison.

03

Compare Outputs

Place the outputs side by side. Look for differences in tone, depth, organisation, and overall quality. Note what surprised you.

04

Analyse Effectiveness

Reflect on which techniques worked best for which content type. Document your findings and identify patterns you can reuse in future projects.

TECHNIQUE 1

Query Decomposition

What It Is

Example Prompt

Query decomposition breaks a complex request into smaller, sequential sub-questions or steps. Instead of asking the AI to handle everything at once, you guide it through a logical progression that builds a more complete and accurate response.

"First, explain what climate change is. Then, list its three main causes. Finally, describe two solutions that governments can implement."

Best For

- Complex research topics
- Multi-part reports
- Step-by-step guides
- Technical explanations

Pro Tip: Number your sub-questions explicitly in the prompt. The AI will follow the sequence more reliably when the order is clearly stated.

TECHNIQUE 2

Decision-Making Prompts

Decision-making prompts ask the AI to evaluate options, weigh trade-offs, and recommend a course of action. These prompts are especially powerful when you need structured analysis rather than just information.

Scenario-Based Framing

Present a realistic situation and ask the AI to reason through it. *"A startup has \$50,000 to invest in marketing. Should they focus*

Criteria-Driven Evaluation

Define the criteria the AI should use to make its decision. *"Evaluate three project management tools based on cost, ease of use,*

Pros and Cons Structure

Explicitly request a balanced analysis before a conclusion. *"List the advantages and disadvantages of remote work for software teams,*

on social media ads or influencer partnerships? Compare both options and recommend one."

and team collaboration features. Rank them and justify your ranking."

then provide a recommendation for a mid-sized company."

TECHNIQUE 3

Semantic Filtering

What It Is

Semantic filtering involves specifying what the AI should **include** and **exclude** from its response. By narrowing the semantic scope, you prevent the AI from drifting into irrelevant territory and keep the output tightly focused on your needs.

Key Phrases to Use

- "Focus only on..."
- "Do not include..."
- "Limit your response to..."
- "Exclude any mention of..."

Example Prompt

"Write a 300-word article about electric vehicles. Focus only on environmental benefits and battery technology. Do not include pricing information or brand comparisons."

Why It Works

Without semantic filtering, AI models tend to cover every angle of a topic. Filtering forces the model to prioritise the dimensions that matter most to your audience and purpose.

TECHNIQUE 4

Structured Prompting

Structured prompting gives the AI a clear template or format to follow. You define the sections, headings, word counts, or even the tone upfront — and the AI fills in the structure with high-quality content. This technique is ideal for professional documents.



Following this four-step workflow ensures your structured prompts are complete and specific, leading to outputs that require minimal editing.

Report Template Prompt

"Write a case study with the following sections: Background (100 words), Challenge (150 words), Solution (200 words), Results (100 words), and Key Takeaways (bullet points)."

Article Template Prompt

"Write a blog article with an engaging introduction, three subheadings with supporting details, and a conclusion with a call to action. Target audience: small business owners."

TECHNIQUE 5

Creative Prompting

Creative prompting unlocks the AI's ability to generate original, imaginative, and emotionally resonant content. These prompts use narrative framing, role-playing, and stylistic direction to push beyond standard informational output.



Role-Playing

Ask the AI to write from a specific persona. *"You are a seasoned travel journalist. Write a feature story about visiting Kyoto in autumn."*



Stylistic Direction

Specify a writing style or literary influence. *"Write a product description in the style of a luxury fashion magazine — evocative, sensory, and aspirational."*



Scenario Building

Create a fictional or hypothetical scenario. *"Imagine it is 2040 and AI tutors are standard in schools. Write a news article about the impact on student performance."*

Comparing Prompt Techniques

Use this reference table to understand when and why to apply each technique. The best prompt engineers do not rely on a single approach — they select and combine techniques based on the content goal.

Technique	Content Type	Strength	Best Used When...
Query Decomposition	Reports, Guides	Logical depth and completeness	The topic has multiple layers or steps
Decision-Making	Analyses, Recommendations	Structured evaluation	You need a reasoned conclusion
Semantic Filtering	Articles, Briefs	Focus and relevance	The topic is broad and needs narrowing

Structured Prompting	Case Studies, Reports	Consistent format	You need a specific document structure
Creative Prompting	Stories, Marketing	Originality and voice	You want engaging, non-standard output

📌 **Remember:** These techniques are not mutually exclusive. A single prompt can combine structured prompting with semantic filtering, or creative prompting with query decomposition. Experiment with combinations to find what works best for your workflow.

Key Takeaways & Next Steps

You now have five powerful prompt patterns in your toolkit. The difference between a mediocre AI output and an exceptional one often comes down to the precision and intention behind your prompt. Use these takeaways to guide your practice.

1 Structure drives quality

A well-organised prompt produces well-organised content. Always think about the format you need before writing your prompt.

2 Specificity reduces revision

The more precisely you define scope, tone, and structure, the less editing you will need to do after generation.

3 Compare and iterate

Run the same topic through two or three different techniques. The differences in output will teach you more than any tutorial.

4 Build your prompt library

Save your most effective prompts. Over time, you will develop a personal library of go-to structures for different content types.

Your challenge: Pick one topic and write five prompts — one for each technique. Generate the outputs, compare them, and write a short reflection on which technique produced the strongest result and why.

